

MAN WITH A PLAN

Rowland Macdonald Stephenson's contributions and successes towards railways in India are summarized in his obituary:

"Macdonald Stephenson never lost heart or patience or temper with any obstacle ... He wrote with a certain difficulty, in a queer way, and he was a little intolerant of fools; but he had always a plan, and always, when dealing with officials, an infinity of persuasiveness. He became the very soul of the undertaking, every engineer under him (and he had one man of genius and many able men) knew he could rely upon support, and however great the difficulties, he demanded that the work should go on and nobody should talk of impossibilities, that non-existent labour should be imported, and that the indispensable class of minor contractors, who did not exist and could not be imported, should be created out of the ground; and so the road rolled on till it reached Delhi."

"... the **Bombayans** ... write, speak, think about **nothing but railways** ..."

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